

Richard Kelsey

Ecommerce and AI consultant for Australian online retailers

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PROFILE

I help Australian online retailers grow their stores and put AI to work where it pays. I co-founded Beer Cartel in 2009 and built it into Australia's #1 online craft beer retailer. Since leaving in September 2025 I have been building with AI, and since May 2026 I consult on ecommerce growth strategy, customer acquisition and practical AI for marketing and operations. Available for consulting, or a full or part time engagement where the fit is right.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant, Digital Marketing and AI Strategy

May 2026 to present

- Ecommerce growth strategy, customer acquisition planning and practical AI implementation for marketing and operations.
- Fixed-price audits (AI search readiness, ecommerce and AI growth), a two-week AI Strategy Sprint, and monthly consulting.

Co-founder, Made 4 Tradies

- Websites for Australian trade businesses.

Co-founder and CEO, Beer Cartel

2009 to September 2025

- Built Australia's #1 online craft beer retailer from a storage shed. Sold in 2024 and stayed on through the transition.
- Owned the full commercial operation: P&L, platform strategy, paid media, email, conversion, team leadership and board reporting.
- Led five platform migrations, including BigCommerce to Shopify, and four email platform implementations or migrations.
- Grew the team from 2 to 30+. Raised \$1.5M in equity and secured \$150K+ in government grants.
- Hands-on work on AI-assisted customer service and marketing personalisation.

Board Member, Retail Drinks Australia

November 2019 to August 2025

- Elected to represent digital and online liquor retailers on the national retail liquor industry body.

RECOGNITION

- Top 50 People in Australian Ecommerce, Inside Retail (2019, 2021, 2022)
- Online Retailer of the Year, Beer & Brewer (5 times)
- Retail Innovator of the Year, ARA; Best Online Retail Marketing, Australia Post; BigCommerce Innovation Awards (2)

AI TRAINING AND TOOLS

- Claude Code in Action (Anthropic, March 2026); courses on generative AI for business leaders, responsible AI and Microsoft Copilot (September 2025).
- Hands-on builder: a personal agent system on the Claude API that handles parts of my daily work.

EDUCATION

- Postgraduate Diploma in Business Administration, Massey University
- Bachelor of Commerce, Marketing and Finance, University of Canterbury